

Debate

SMaiLE Project

Key Information

Target Group: 4 - 7 y.o.

Duration: 40 minutes

Key Learning Goals:

1. **Critical Thinking:** Begin to think about fairness, kindness, and big ethical questions about technology.
2. **Speaking and Listening:** Practise sharing ideas clearly and listening respectfully to others.
3. **Collaboration:** Work with a partner to talk, share, and create together.
4. **Creative Expression:** Use drawing and design to express feelings and opinions.

Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

KNOWLEDGE & UNDERSTANDING:

- Understand what robots and Artificial Intelligence are in simple terms.
- Recognize that people can have different ideas or opinions.
- Identify some things a robot can do and some things only a person can do.
- Understand that it is important to ask if something is fair, kind, or helpful.

SKILLS & ABILITIES:

- Listen carefully to a story and follow along.
- Share their own thoughts clearly using sentence starters.
- Work with a partner to discuss ideas using Think–Pair–Share.
- Agree or disagree respectfully and give a simple reason.
- Express ideas creatively through drawing and facial expressions.



ATTITUDES & VALUES:

- Show curiosity about how robots work and what they can do.
- Respect other children's ideas, even if they are different.
- Develop empathy by thinking about how others feel.
- Begin to think about using technology in a kind and fair way.

European Dimension / Erasmus+ Connection

- **Fairness and Inclusion:** Encourages discussion around kindness, fairness, and respect.
- **Early Digital Literacy:** Introduces ethical awareness linked to responsible technology use.
- **Active Citizenship:** Promotes listening, cooperation, and respectful dialogue in the classroom.



1. Resources and Tools

- **Story Resources:** “My Teacher is a Robot” and other age-appropriate robot stories or videos.
- **Visuals:** Simple pictures of real robots in schools, hospitals, or homes.
- **Materials:** Printed story or digital display, robot face templates, coloring pencils or crayons.
- **Optional Props:** Agree/disagree signs and open floor space for movement.

Useful Links

- [Robot story video 1](#)
- [Robot story video 2](#)
- [The Robot Bedtime Book](#)
- [Six Silly Robots PDF](#)
- [OhMyTales robot stories collection](#)
- [Robbie the Robot story](#)

2. Working Methods

- **Storytelling and Discussion:** Reading a simple story to spark thinking.
- **Think–Pair–Share:** Helping children reflect and talk with support.
- **Mini-Debate Warm-Up:** Agree/disagree activities using body movement or signs.
- **Creative Expression:** Drawing and coloring to represent opinions and emotions.
- **Display and Reflect:** Creating a classroom wall that shows diverse views.

Activity Overview

Duration	Activity	Description
5 min	Introduction and Motivation	Introduce debate as sharing ideas, explain robots simply, and read “My Teacher is a Robot”.
10 min	Think–Pair–Share	Children reflect quietly, talk with a partner, and share what they liked or found strange.
10 min	Mini-Debate	Children respond to simple agree/disagree statements and give reasons.
15 min	Evaluation and Creative Task	Children color and design a robot teacher template and explain their choices.

3. Introduction and Motivation

Goal: Introduce debate and big thinking questions about fairness.

- Explain that people can have different opinions and still listen kindly.
- Introduce robots as machines that can help people in different places.



- Read the simple story “My Teacher is a Robot” aloud.
- Ask whether a robot teacher would feel the same as a real teacher.

4. Research and Learning

Goal: Think about what a robot teacher can and cannot do.

- Discuss the story and ask what the robot did well.
- Notice what felt strange or missing, such as playfulness or empathy.
- Use Think–Pair–Share with prompts such as “I think a robot teacher is ___ because ___.”
- Record ideas on the board under headings like “What we liked” and “What felt strange”.

5. Creative Application

Goal: Let children express and justify an opinion.

- Read simple agree/disagree statements aloud, for example: “A robot teacher can help you learn just as well as a person.”
- Children respond with movement, thumbs up/down, or printed signs.
- Encourage reasons such as “I agree because...” or “I disagree because...”.
- Children then color a robot template and choose an expression such as happy, sad, helpful, or unhelpful.

6. Reflection and Evaluation

Goal: Link creative choices to the debate.

- Children explain why they made their robot good or bad, happy or sad, helpful or unhelpful.
- Display the finished robots on a wall, for example “Good Robot Teachers” vs. “Bad Robot Teachers”.
- Use the display as a class summary of the debate and a prompt for final reflection.